

FINAL SUMMER INTERNSHIP REPORT (May 12th to June 12th)

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I would also like to mention and thank the CRC team of our institute, who worked relentlessly hard and helped me secure a placement at India's top NGO. This not only gave a boost to my CV but also allowed me to understand the level of hierarchy and delegation that takes place in large firms.

I would also like to thank my mentor, Prof. Ritu Raj, without whose constant guidance and support, this internship and report wouldn't be possible.

Lastly, I would like to thank my parents, my brother, and my fellow interns who made sure I completed my internship with me being at my best and being the constant motivator to me to inculcate more ideas, time, and energy to get the most out of me for the firm and the cause.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The report covers every aspect of the internship period. There are three sections in the report: A, B, and C. Part A of the report contains information about the organisation, including history and details of the NGO, details of the Office Bearers, Size of the NGO, Vision and Mission of the organisation, projects, and beneficiaries.

Part B contains the details of the organisation that includes introduction, methodology, context of industry problems, presentations of data and analysis, and discussions.

Part C contains a brief description of the learnings, challenges, and experiences while in the NGO.

PART A: PROFILE OF THE ORGANIZATION

A.1 History

In 1979, Rippa Kapur founded Child Rights and You (CRY) to promote happier childhoods for India's children. Rippan opted to start CRY as an organization that not only pushed Indian citizens to find their capacity for action and contribute to the solution, but also provided local NGOs with the funding and technical knowledge they needed to make a long-term impact on the ground. In 1994, the visionary founder, Rippan Kapur, passed away.

As part of the National Alliance for the Fundamental Right to Education (NAFRE), CRY took part in the 'Voice of India' campaign to propose a constitutional change to the government for free and compulsory education for all children.

NAFRE contributed to the passage of the Right of Children to Free and Compulsory Education Act, 2009, because of the "Voice of India" campaign.

CRY is a member of several international children's rights organizations, including Girls Not Brides and the National Action and Coordination Group for Ending Violence Against Children (NACG-EVAC). NACG-EVAC is a national platform that operates under the auspices of SAIEVAC, an intergovernmental platform made up of eight SAARC countries.

A.2 Awards and Recognition

In over 4 decades, CRY has received many awards in recognition of its work towards enabling better futures for underprivileged children.

- Awarded to Puja Marwaha, CEO - CRY, For Social Innovation (2018)
- Best Multi-Channel Campaign for A Cause (#YellowFellow 2018)
- ICAI CSR Award for Best CSR Project in Health & Education (2014)
- CFBP Jamnalal Bajaj Award for Fair Business Practices (2014)
- Quality Initiative Mission Award (2013)
- Citi Woman Leader Awarded to Puja Marwaha, CEO - CRY (2012)
- Fundraising Campaign Award (2011 & 2012)
- Lakshya Award (2009 & 2012)
- Indira Super Achiever Award (2003)
- Marketing Excellence Award for Social Awareness (2001)
- Viewer's Choice Most Effective Ad of the Year (1996)
- Citizen of Bombay Award for Rippan Kapur (1991)
- Most Trusted Ngo (2018)
- One of the top one hundred Non-Profit Organizations in the World (2018)

A.3 Why Children?

Children make up about 40% of India's population, with 472 million. Despite this, only 3.16 percent of the Union Budget for 2020 has been allocated for their development and welfare. The National Plan of Action for Children advises allocating 5% of the country's GDP to children, even though India's GDP has been stagnant at 0.43 for the past two years.

As a result, India's youngsters face some of the world's most dreadful conditions. Between the ages of 6 and 18, an estimated forty-six million children do not attend school (RGI Census Population Projection 2016 and UDISE 2016-17).

- Instead of going to school, thirty-three million children labor (Census 2011)
- India has one out of every three child brides in the globe (UNICEF 2014)
- Malnutrition kills two out of every three children under the age of five (UNICEF 2019)
- 7.4 million youngsters remain unvaccinated, the largest number in the world (UNICEF)
- Between 2008 and 2018, there was a 500 percent increase in crimes against children (NCRB 2018)

All children have fundamental rights, according to the United Nations Convention on the Rights of the Child (UNCRC), which India adopted in 1992. Governments and citizens must respect these rights alike. CRY focuses on four crucial areas:

- Education is important (Right to Development)
- Nutrition & Health (Right to Survival)
- Participation of Children (Right to Participation)
- Protection & Safety (Right to Protection)

A.4 Vision

The vision of the organization aims at making the youth of our nation happy, healthy, and creative, and making sure that their rights are protected and honored in a society that is built on respect for dignity, justice, and equity for all.

A.5 Approach and Impact

Approach

Child Rights and You believes in sustainable change. Their approach is based on the idea of bringing about change at all levels, including Grassroot and Systematic. Their goal is to work with a variety of stakeholders, including children, parents, teachers, Anganwadi communities, and governments at the district and state levels. Their goal is to change behaviours and practices and work their way up to policies.

Impact

Over the past 45 years, CRY has left its mark in various segments but has always prioritized education, healthcare, and the protection of children over others. It has participated in various campaigns, movements and has always been a significant contributor to the development of our youth.

Advocacy Efforts

➤ Free and Compulsory Education for India's Children: CRY participated in the 'Voice of India' campaign, as a part of the National Alliance for the Fundamental Right to Education (NAFRE), to propose a constitutional amendment to the government for free and compulsory education to all children. As a result of the 'Voice of India' campaign, NAFRE contributed towards bringing in the Right of Children to Free and Compulsory Education Act, 2009.

➤ Member of Technical and Advisory Committees: CRY is recognized as a child rights expert and is a member of NITI Aayog's subcommittee on 'Child Rights and Child Protection.' CRY is also on the Central Advisory Board on Child and Adolescent Labor under the Ministry of Labor and Employment.

➤ Providing Technical Support in Policy Making: CRY provided technical support to State governments in drafting the following policies:

- Chhattisgarh State Policy for Children
- Manipur State Policy for Children

- Jharkhand State Policy for Early Childhood Care and Education

➤ Sensitizing Policy Makers to the Needs of Godsend: CRY conducted an in-depth study, based on secondary data, on the status and needs of children between 15-18 years of age – the first of its kind that recognized those over the age of fourteen as children as well. The resulting report, “Children in India: We Are Children too!” was presented to policymakers, academicians, and practitioners.

➤ Enabling Capacity Building of Government Schools on Child Rights: CRY makes submissions to various relevant Ministries and statutory bodies, which has contributed towards system strengthening and capacity building of government officials on child education including early childhood care and development, elementary education as well as juvenile justice, child labor, child trafficking, child marriage and child sexual abuse.

PART B: PROJECT WORK

B.1 Experiential Learning Project [TYPE - 3]

B.1.1 Introduction:

Summer Vacation turned into Summer Reflection. Instead of relaxing, my mind was racing, with thoughts concerning the children in poor areas, how they live, what brings them joy, are they happy? Or could they ever be? We whine about a mixed vacation, whereas they do not get a vacation their whole lives. My reflection made me angry, on myself, on my peers, who relate with depression posts on social media on the slightest inconvenience. How stupid, how hypocritical we are, so out of touch with reality and the world, in our own dreamland created by our father's hard-earned money and our mother's shield of affection.

I interned at the Child Rights and You (CRY) organisation. An NGO (Non-Governmental Organisation) that works for children all over India and also in some parts worldwide. I was working under CRY Kolkata on its operations in Durgapur at Kada Road, a red-light area. There is a primary, bigger CRY centre just beside a primary government school. In addition, there are three other centres in the surrounding areas. Even though the whole of Kada Road is called a red-light area, there is a division between red-light and non-red-light areas inside Kada Road. The non-red-light area consists of migrant workers from Uttar Pradesh and Bihar who are non-Bangalis, while the red-light area consists of sex workers, many from Bangladesh, who were compelled into sex work due to financial restraints. The children in the proper red-light area mostly do not have a father. Children in both areas are vulnerable as both are exposed to communal violence, domestic violence, sexual violence, and the like. The households are classified into red, purple, yellow, and green based on their financial conditions: mainly on the factor of type of employment of the main breadwinner, the male head of the family, whether weekly paid labour or monthly paid, green being a secure household, red meaning insecure/vulnerable. Unsurprisingly, most households fall into the red category.

I interned for a month, from May 12th to June 12th, 2025. So that is basically four work weeks. First week from 12th May to 18th May, second week from 19th May to 25th May, third week from 26th May to 1st June, and the fourth and final week from 2nd June to 8th June. Along with me were three of my colleagues: Mr. Divyangsu Chatterjee, my roommate in hostel, Mr. Siddhartha Maitra, and Mr. Archisman Das. All of us were assigned to the CRY Kolkata office. I opted for operations at Kada Road in Durgapur while the others, being from Kolkata itself, chose either Khidderpore or Brace Bridge. Weekly details are written below.

B.1.2 Week 1 [from May 12th to May 18th]:

My CRY internship kicked off on Monday, May 12th. The day before, Sunday, my mentor, Miss Rubina Haque (we call her Rubina Ma'am), let us know we could work from home that first Monday – a nice surprise!

That first online day was our intro session. Rubina Ma'am met with me and three other students from my college who are also interning in Kolkata. She explained what CRY is all about – fighting for children's rights – and what we'd be doing for the next four weeks. She gave us some helpful documents about how things work at CRY and basic office manners. She also asked us to send our CVs so she could figure out the best tasks for each of us. I told her I was based in Durgapur, and she said that was fine; she'd assign me to work with the CRY team there.

Tuesday was also work-from-home. We just got a heads-up that there'd be an online meeting the next day.

Wednesday was the meeting with Mr. Ashim Ghosh on Microsoft Teams. He talked about how NGOs work, especially CRY's focus on helping kids. Then he gave us some homework! He asked us to look up five important things:

1. UNCRC (The UN's rules on children's rights)
2. UN SDGs (The UN's big goals for a better world)
3. The Child Rights Commission Act (2005) in India
4. Mission Vatsalya (An Indian child welfare scheme)
5. NCPCR (India's national child rights protection group)

After we researched these, we had to make a PowerPoint to present next week. Mr. Ghosh also told me directly that I should meet him in person in Durgapur on Friday.

Thursday was all about hitting the books (or the internet!). I spent the day learning about NGOs and child rights, gathering info for my presentation.

Friday was my big first day out in the field! I put on my nice shirt and pants, grabbed my college ID and a pen, and headed to meet Mr. Ashim Ghosh at Hotel Park Prime in Durgapur. We hopped in an auto-rickshaw and went to the CRY centre on Kada Road. I spent about four hours there, meeting the staff, chatting with them, and getting shown around. Here's what I learned and saw:

- **Different Centres:** CRY runs four centres near Kada Road, split up based on how many houses are in each neighbourhood. Two are in the Red Light Area, and two are not.
- **Kids Needing Help:** Kids in both areas face tough times. In the Red Light Area, it's often because dads aren't around and money is really tight. In the Non-Red Light Area

(like the centre I was at), problems like violence at home and not having enough money make life hard for the kids.

- **My Centre:** This centre helps a Non-Red Light Area. They have about 171 kids signed up, aged from 6 to 18, but mostly teenagers (11-16). It's right next door to the local school.
- **What They Do:** CRY gives kids a safe, happy place to learn ("Joyful Learning") – something they might not get at home. They get extra help with English, Maths, and Hindi (because lots of families here speak Hindi, not Bengali) to catch up with school. They also have special "Life Skills" classes to help kids feel more confident, learn about staying clean and healthy, and how to get along with others. On weekends, they even have Karate classes!
- **The Team:** Six people work here: five teachers (for the subjects, Life Skills, and Karate) and one person (the Social Representative) who talks to the community and collects information.
- **Timings:** Classes happen every day from 3 PM to 6 PM, after regular school lets out.
- **Success Stories:** I asked if any kids from here had big dreams or did well. One of my colleagues said yes! One kid got the top marks in the whole area in their 10th-grade exams. Another is now studying for a Polytechnic diploma at Sanaka Educational Trust in Durgapur. That was cool to hear.

After seeing the centre, the Social Representative took me around the neighbourhood and pointed out where the other three centres are. Mr. Ghosh explained my job for the next ten days: I'd help the staff collect information (data) and later on, I might even help run some sessions with the kids. He said regular classes were paused for the next couple of weeks because of summer holidays, so right now, it was all about gathering data. Mrs. Priyanka Pandey introduced herself and said she'd be the one telling Rubina Ma'am how I was doing.

Honestly, by the end of the tour, I was feeling pretty rough. The heat was intense, the area was very new and different for me, and I just started feeling sick. So, I headed straight home after the tour.

B.1.3 Week 2 [from May 19th to May 25th]:

This week threw me right into the heart of CRY's Durgapur operations. It was incredibly busy – lots of desk time mixed with intense field visits that wore me out physically.

Offline Work (Mon-Wed):

- **Attendance Tracking:** Spent Monday, Tuesday, and Wednesday mornings deep in Microsoft Excel. My main job was updating the attendance records for kids across all four CRY centres near Kada Road. It was detailed, sometimes tedious work, checking names and dates against the paper registers.
- **Community Visits:** Things changed pace around 4 PM each afternoon. I joined the full-time CRY staff for field visits in the Non-Red-Light Area part of the community.

This meant walking door-to-door. We'd talk to families, ask how things were going, and strongly encourage them to send their kids to the CRY centre for extra school help. A big part was explaining why keeping kids in education matters so much for their future.

- **The Daily Grind:** My on-site shift ran from 12 PM to 6 PM, three days this week. Just the travel to and from the main centre (which has nearly 200 kids enrolled!) took 80 minutes each day. The centre itself was tough – only fans battling the intense May heat. Honestly, by mid-afternoon, the combination of spreadsheet focus and the heat left me feeling completely drained.

Observations from the Field:

- **Location Sensitivity:** Explaining my internship location to friends requires some careful wording because of Kada Road's reputation. It's not a typical corporate office setting.
- **The Community:** The Non-Red Light Area we worked in is mostly small, simple houses ("bastis") and tiny shops. Nearly everyone we met migrated here from Bihar or Uttar Pradesh, working in nearby factories.
- **Doorstep Challenges:** Local teenage girls often helped guide us. But not every interaction was smooth. People sometimes got wary or even angry, especially about photos. One time, a resident reacted strongly to us taking pictures. My colleague quickly stepped in, explaining clearly it was *only* for CRY's internal reports. It was a sharp lesson in needing to be extra careful and respectful here.
- **The Team:** Worked alongside CRY's dedicated field staff. They're all full-time, really knowledgeable, and each holds an MSW (Masters in Social Work) degree.

The Commute & A Personal Turning Point:

Getting home after that first field day was an ordeal! We took a Toto (auto-rickshaw) to Main Gate, waited ages (felt like 20 mins!) for a packed bus to Durgapur Station, then finally an auto home. Total travel time: nearly an hour. Sitting on that hot, crowded bus, completely exhausted, a big realization hit me: Trying to manage a demanding full-time job *like this* while prepping for tough competitive exams just wouldn't work. It made me seriously rethink my plan to find a job immediately after my BBA solely for experience. I kept remembering Mom's advice about finishing my studies first – she was right.

Online Work (Thu-Sun):

Thankfully, Thursday and Friday were work-from-home. After the intensity onsite, it felt like a needed breather. Tasks were simpler: mainly wrapping up the attendance records. This included adding details for the kids and parents who came to CRY's weekend health camp (held Saturday & Sunday, May 24th & 25th).

Non-NGO Venture:

For the remaining week I was engaged with another work and will be the following week too, that is, acting. A friend of mine who makes short films offered me a role in his new project, another short film called 'নেতারহাট জমজমাট' (Netarhat Jomjomat). The story is based in the **Feluda** Universe, a new story including characters from **Feluda** and a few new ones as

the story and the script demanded. **Feluda** is a fictional detective, private investigator created by **Satyajit Ray**, the Oscar winner Indian-Bangali film director, screenwriter, author, lyricist, magazine editor, illustrator, calligrapher, and composer. Ray is widely considered one of the greatest and most influential film directors in the *history of cinema*. Our story includes a murder in a hill station called Netarhat, many probable suspects and Feluda along with Topshe (his nephew) and Ratul (Topshe's cousin) solving the case.

B.1.3 Week 3 [from May 26th to June 1st]:

My offline work days changed this week (Thursday 29th, Friday 30th, Saturday 31st May) due to the filming project I talked about last time. Honestly, it was exhausting. I worked every day, juggling the NGO and filming, and the filming days were especially long and demanding.

At the NGO office, I was back working with Excel on student attendance data. I had this huge document listing every student from all four centres. My job was to look up their details (name, date of birth, age, mother's and father's names, grade, school, and their CRY centre) whenever a colleague gave me a name. They were entering the data into KoboCollect, and I'd read out the info from my Excel sheet for them to type in. That filled up my three days there.

This week really showed me that work often involves sticking with tasks that feel routine. Sometimes you just have to push through and get it done.

B.1.4 Week 4 [from June 2nd to June 8th]:

This week (June 2nd-4th), I worked offline, Monday through Wednesday. Mornings were spent updating student attendance in Excel, but afternoons were different – I taught four classes across our centres.

Monday hit me hard. At the main center, my first class had 25 kids – migrant workers' children from UP and Bihar, all Hindi-speaking. Grades 4-7 mostly, plus one tiny first-grader. I ditched the syllabus and talked about *infinity* – their wide-eyed stares made my chest tighten. Then we explored how Hindi, Bangla, and even English all sprouted from the same ancient roots. I showed them Central Asia on the globe and said that is where the Proto-Indo-European language began.

We did introductions next. "What do you love doing at home?" I asked. Many girls said, "पढ़ना" (studying). Dreams? Doctors, police officers, teachers... and one sharp-eyed boy who declared, "Businessman!" He turned the tables: asked what I want to be? That sparked a whole detour – explaining college, my BBA degree, and finally admitting that I want to be a businessman too.

Before dismissing the class, I told them two things that mattered:

- ① "Someone at IIT Bombay isn't smarter than you. They just had different chances."
- ② Told them how every living thing – trees, ants, us – came from one tiny cell that got lucky billions of years ago. "We're all family," I said. This one girl in the front didn't blink once, soaking in every word.

The 4 PM class? Only five older girls showed up. We covered similar ground – languages, equality, that ancient cell. *Again*, one girl listened like her life depended on it.

Tuesday changed something in me. After attending work, my colleague took me to a center *in the red-light area*. "Teach English basics," she said. "These kids have seen very little school."

Eight kids arrived, all Bangalis. The proper red-light area is Bangali-dominated, while the non-red-light area of Kada Road is dominated by non-Bangalis from Uttar Pradesh and Bihar.

I discussed topics such as the solar system, the universe, Atoms, World War 2 et cetera.

I assigned five 5-letter words, five fruits, and five flowers as homework. Her smile after receiving homework made me want to cry.

Walking back, my colleague shared quiet truths:

- This centre shields kids from their mothers' clients, who sometimes see the children "that way."
- Almost all mothers here are in sex work. However,
- Why? "Imagine a husband vanishing under debt. Loan sharks at the door. Hungry children. No choices left." Every mother's story was written in survival.

Wednesday was my last day offline. Morning Excel work, then a drawing class from 4-6 PM. Twenty-five kids, five groups, chart paper everywhere. I handed out crayons, settled disputes over the green one, and watched them create. Simple. Peaceful.

What's sitting with me:

In every class, a *single* girl was leaning forward, listening like knowledge was oxygen. These kids see violence, hunger, fathers gone, mothers broken... yet that spark in them? Unkillable. Meanwhile, I've had every door opened for me and still complain about morning lectures.

Seeing their reality didn't just "teach gratitude." It *slammed* into me. For two weeks after, I couldn't write this. Just sat with this heavy, humbling truth: My life has everything theirs lacks. That little girl begging for homework? Her voice won't leave me. It's screaming: *Use what you've been given. Do something that matters.*

B.1.5 More about the Kada Road CRY Centre:

The operations are funded by Durgapur Municipal Corporation (DMC), and the yearly budget is close to 24 Lakhs. I overheard conversations of my colleagues discussing a recent development, according to which CRY operations in that centre might be ceased, and unsurprisingly, all were very disgruntled; they also said how 24 lakhs of budget a year is too low for an operation of such scale.

The Kada Road operation has a seven-member team. At the helm is Mrs. Priyanka Pandey, who receives instructions from the head office of CRY Kolkata. Mr. Sanjit Ram is the data collector and social representative, and also takes games classes. One Karate instructor takes sessions on Fridays, Saturdays, and Sundays. The rest are teaching staff teaching the

following subjects: English, Mathematics, and Life Skills. Each one of the four teaching staff members has one of the four centres in the Kada Road area under their care; they are tasked with maintaining the enrolment of students and their attendance in their respective registers.

The work they do is often not considered much in the general society, people think it doesn't require much to do these jobs, even though everyone I worked with has a Master's in Social Work degree, so they are properly educated.

Progress is present, but very slow. Domestic violence is very prevalent in households. Almost every day, I heard from my colleagues about a man beating his wife while drunk. Without collective community efforts, real change is impossible. India has a huge margin of population living in these conditions, and the only thing uniting most of these people is either political affiliation, religious affiliation, or hate. Determined, motivated, energetic, enthusiastic, and driven, Government intervention and efforts are needed to uplift these people, take them out of misery and addiction. Without the upliftment of all, India cannot progress in human development terms.



Figure 1: My Colleague is enquiring about the wage regularity (monthly or daily) from the residents of the area for data collection purposes



Figure 2: A glimpse of the housing conditions of the area



Figure 3: A Goat



Figure 4: The centre where I am posted (one of the four CRY centres around the area)



Figure 5: A picture of myself (centre) with four girl children enrolled in the CRY centres who were also assisting me and my colleague with the field visit



Figure 6: Me enquiring about the financial and employment conditions from a local worker

Health Camp

23.5.2025

Sl. No.	Name of the beneficiary/Class	Gender (M/F)	Name of the child/ children (If beneficiary is a parent/ guardian)	Sign. Of the benef.
1.	Madhu Balanika	F	Madhu	
2.	Animesh Badyakar	M	Animesh	
3.	Barsha Ghosh	F	Barsha Ghosh	
4.	Alo Badyakar	F	Alo Badyakar	
5.	Gouranga Badyakar	M	Gouranga	
6.	Anjali Yadav	F	Anjali Yadav	
7.	Anshu Kumari	F	Anshu Kumari	
8.	Preeti Kumari	F	Preeti Kumari	
9.	Riya Singh	F	Riya Singh	
10.	Aditya Singh	M	Aditya Singh	
11.	Kunal Badyakar	M	Kunal	
12.	Bittu Badyakar	M	Bittu	
13.	Ankur Badyakar	M	ANKUR Badyakar	
14.	Shikha Badyakar	F	Shikha Badyakar	
15.	Aditya Shari	M	Aditya Shari	
16.	Anshu Shari	F	Anshu Shari	
17.	Pravabati Kumari	F	Pravabati Kumari	
18.	Sanjit Mandal	M	Sanjit	
19.	Sonika Choudhary	F	Sonika	
20.	Pia Badyakar	F	Pia	
21.	Srabanti Badyakar	F	Srabanti	
22.	Piya Badyakar	F	Piya	
23.	Laxmi Kumari	F	Laxmi Kumari	
24.	Rajni Kumari	F	Rajni Kumari	
25.	Ranjana Prasad	F	Ranjana Kumari	
26.	Avinash Badyakar	M	Avinash	
27.	Anjali Badyakar	F	ANALI	
28.	Suram Badyakar	M	Suram	
29.	Piya Badyakar	F	Piya Badyakar	
30.	Chaitanya Badyakar	F	Chaitanya Badyakar	
31.	Pallabi Badyakar	F	Pallabi Badyakar	
32.	Suraj Rana	M	Suraj Rana	
33.	Rishi Yadav	M	Rishi Yadav	
34.	Indu Balanika	F	Indu	
35.	Sagar Badyakar	M	Sagar Badyakar	
36.	Siddhanta Badyakar	M	Siddhanta	
37.	Deep Badyakar	M	Deep Badyakar	
38.	Priya Rajak	F	Priya	
39.	Riya Kumari Rajak	F	Riya Kumari Rajak	
40.	Pritham Rajak	M	Pritham	
41.	Puzpa Badyakar	F	Puzpa	
42.	Vola Badyakar	M	Vola	
43.	Ankita Badyakar	F	ANKITA	
44.	Anupam Shari	M	Anupam	
45.	Sandhya Yadav	F	Sandhya Yadav	
46.	Parul Badyakar	F	Parul Badyakar	
47.	Phul Kumari	F	Phul Kumari	
48.	Anadi Kumari	F	Anadi Kumari	
49.	Lakhi Badyakar	F	Lakhi	
50.	Robi Sen		Robi Sen	

Figure 7: A page from the health camp attendance register



Figure 8: Me taking a session [1]



Figure 9: Me taking a session [2]



Figure 10: My Last Day at CRY, Kada Road

PART C: LEARNINGS

My work primarily involved documenting in MS Excel; therefore, I was able to review and apply basic concepts such as creating workbooks, entering data, using formulas, formatting cells, and creating charts, which are typically taught in 6th and 7th grade. I practiced features of data analysis—sorting, finding, filtering, and formatting.

Interning at CRY, I acquired a wide range of soft skills.

Teaching the kids at the NGO was part of the job, as a result of which I learned and improved upon my communication abilities. I came across children of underprivileged people- sex workers, labourers, orphans, who were taken under the wings of CRY. They led a tough life with no ambition to enhance their lives. They lacked even the most basic resources, which led them to be grateful for even the mildest of efforts shown towards them. They never had a proper source of education; hence, I decided to start from the very basics of Mathematics and English. I explained to them the Number Line and how it's useful for even higher levels of mathematics. I tried to teach them a simplified version of what infinity means. As for English, I revised the alphabet and asked them to name the objects present in the room. I usually taught three classes, out of which only a handful of children had the genuine knack for learning. I used to stir up a conversation in between classes and got to know about their poor financial backgrounds. They weren't able to even enroll in government schools. But they were grateful to the advances made by the NGO.

It's often said how kids can turn out to be a handful, though it might be true, one should also look at it from a separate angle, i.e., it teaches us patience and passive control. To manage classes and make every kid feel like an individual is a difficult job; thus, every class I took, I held an introductory session where the students stood up and at the least said their name out loud.

I took a total of five classes, two of them being invigilated drawing sessions. I taught various subjects and topics, including Mathematics, English, History, Geography, and Equality. Each class was one hour each.

I brushed up on my skills in public speaking and teaching. I enhanced my hold on how to convey complex information in an accessible and simple manner. As Einstein famously quoted, "If one cannot explain it simply, one doesn't understand it well enough". These opportunities also helped me develop leadership skills, active listening, and effective team management.

Although I was initially inclined to teach kids and work with NGOs, I realised that pursuing this path wouldn't be realistic at this stage of my life. Such work often demands long-term commitment, full-time focus, and, more importantly, financial support as well as stability. Such work requires an external source of funding. However, the most practical approach to ever contribute to such organisations will be to focus on building a more stable career foundation before fully dedicating myself to such a cause. As time goes on and I accumulate a decent amount of money, I will have also gathered valuable experiences and will have grown into a more mature human being. Nonetheless, I hope to contribute to such causes by part-time volunteering.

REFERENCES:

<https://www.cry.org/> (CRY NGO's Official website)